LA CUCINA ITALIANA - SEMPLICE ITALIAN KITCHEN | PROTEIN-RICH ITALIAN MEALS

High-Protein Chicken Pesto Pasta with White Beans & Green Beans (44g Protein Meal Prep)

Pack 44g of protein into your lunches with this 25-minute High-Protein Chicken Pesto Pasta for Meal Prep! Stays creamy for 4 days. Includes free PDF card.

Prep: 10 mins | Cook: 15 mins | Total: 25 mins | Yield: 4 meal-prep bowls | Calories: 530 kcal

INGREDIENTS CHECKLIST

[ ] 600g (1.3 lbs) Boneless Skinless Chicken Breasts (cut into bite-sized medallions)
[ ] 320g (11 oz) Bronze-Die Short Pasta (Fusilli, Penne, or Chickpea Pasta)
[ ] 200g Fresh Green Beans (Trimmed & Halved)
[ ] 120g (1/2 cup) Fresh Basil Pesto Genovese
[ ] 1/3 cup blended with pasta water Secret Meal-Prep Creamy Booster: Cannellini Beans or Greek Yogurt (keeps pesto creamy for 4 days in fridge)
[ ] 40g Parmigiano, 1 cup tomatoes Grated Parmigiano-Reggiano & Cherry Tomatoes

STEP-BY-STEP CULINARY INSTRUCTIONS

Step 1: Pan-Sear the Italian Herb Chicken [6 mins]

Season chicken medallions with Italian oregano, garlic powder, sea salt, and black pepper. Sear in 1 tablespoon olive oil over medium-high heat for 6 minutes until golden and cooked through (165F).

Step 2: Boil Pasta & Green Beans Together [9 mins]

Cook fusilli or penne in salted boiling water for 9 minutes, tossing in the green beans for the final 3 minutes so they stay bright green and crisp-tender. Reserve 1/2 cup pasta water.

Step 3: Whisk the No-Split Meal-Prep Pesto Sauce [2 mins]

Whisk basil pesto with 3 tablespoons of warm starchy pasta water (plus 2 tablespoons blended white beans or ricotta) so the sauce stays creamy and never separates when reheated.

Step 4: Combine & Portion into 4 Glass Containers

Toss warm pasta, green beans, seared chicken, and halved cherry tomatoes with the creamy pesto emulsion. Divide into 4 airtight meal-prep containers for up to 4 days.

CHEF'S PRO TIPS & STORAGE

* Why Meal-Prep Pesto Usually Gets Oily: Straight oil-based pesto separates when microwaved. Emulsifying it with starchy pasta water and a spoonful of blended white beans or ricotta locks in a creamy texture all week!
* Enjoy cold as an Italian pasta salad or reheat for 90 seconds with a splash of water.